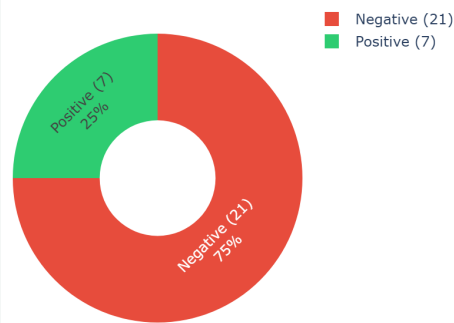


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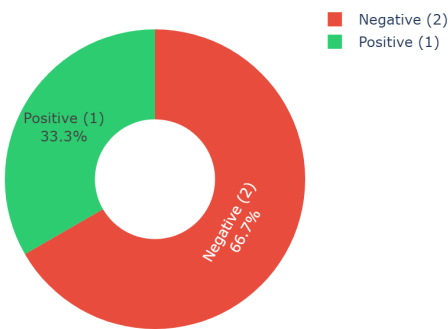
15 March 2026

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Summary

Pakistan’s energy sector faces existential strain amid volatile global markets, geopolitical shocks, and domestic policy inertia. Rising fuel prices, subsidy burdens, and supply chain bottlenecks threaten inflation, power generation, and the \$6bn current account deficit. While digital monitoring and renewables aim to bolster security, stalled reforms and import diversification fail to offset fragility. U.S. energy dominance—via LNG deals, SMRs, and “drill, baby, drill”—intensifies global supply risks, forcing Pakistan into deeper economic vulnerability. Industry leaders warn of collapse, demanding urgent reform, infrastructure, and realignment to avert crisis amid escalating global volatility and rising energy insecurity.

Key Energy Topics

Net Metering

Why does the port of Fujairah matter to the oil market?

UAE's Fujairah port, a critical crude and fuel hub near Hormuz, halted operations after a drone attack. With 1.7Mbpd exports and major blending/storage capacity, disruptions threaten global supply amid Iran war-induced Strait closures, forcing UAE to reroute via ADCOP pipeline—potentially impacting OPEC production and global fuels markets....

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US assures of 'reliable' energy supply to Asia-Pacific - World - DAWN.COM

U.S. energy dominance amid Middle East conflict: Surge in oil prices, halted Hormuz traffic, and U.S. pledges to secure Asia-Pacific supply. \$30B+ deals announced; Japan invests \$550B for tariff relief. Renewables push via SMR partnerships (Hitachi, GE Vernova); LNG deal with Hanwha. Trump's "drill, baby, drill" policy boosts oil profits amid global mineral and energy diversification efforts....

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Solarization

War Diary Day 15: Strikes on Iran's Kharg Island escalate energy war - World - DAWN.COM

US strikes Kharg Island to signal pressure amid Iran's retaliatory operations across Gulf, Iraq, Lebanon, and Yemen. Energy markets remain volatile as oil exports intact, but strategic disruptions threaten global trade. Renewables gain traction as geopolitical tensions escalate, with regional alliances expanding and energy infrastructure targeted to amplify economic stakes....

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Privatisation

Jamshoro Power Company Ltd protests to Railways over delay in coal supply - Business - DAWN.COM

Pakistan's Jamshoro Power Plant faces closure risks due to alleged rail transport delays by Pakistan Railways, citing non-payment of freight charges. JPCL disputes blame, noting contractual obligations and operational differences from Sahiwal. Renewables not mentioned; financial and logistics tensions persist amid coal supply disruptions....

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Tariff Hikes

Fuel Price Adjustment

Load Shedding

PCDMA says Rs55 fuel price hike hurting trade, raising business costs

Pakistan's petroleum price hike (Rs55/litre) is straining industry, with trade groups warning of rising costs, inflation, and export decline. Industry leaders urge urgent government intervention to stabilize energy prices and reduce business burdens, citing electricity tariff cuts as temporary relief amid persistent fuel cost pressures....

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Hiked POL prices begin to inflict serious damage on economy, warns PCDMA - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Pakistan's sudden Rs55/litre petrol-diesel hike threatens industries, urging government to stabilize energy prices. PCDMA warns rising costs risk inflation, export decline, and economic instability, calling for urgent policy realignment to support trade and industrial recovery amid already high electricity and raw material costs....

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Global shocks spark calls for Thar coal use

Pakistan seeks to reduce fuel vulnerability by accelerating Thar coal use across sectors, targeting power and cement industries. Despite rising imported coal prices, government efforts focus on blending mandates, easing financing hurdles, and boosting local bank lending—critical amid geopolitical risks and global energy volatility....

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The price of war

Geopolitical tensions in the Gulf threaten Pakistan's energy and supply chains, driving up fuel, food, and pharmaceutical costs. Fuel scarcity risks disrupting transport and telecom services, while import-dependent sectors face cascading price hikes. Economic vulnerability amplifies these shocks, with rising global freight costs and insurance premiums further straining a debt-laden economy....

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No let-up in ME tensions: RLNG supply crunch hits power sector hard - Business Recorder

Pakistan faces severe RLNG shortages due to Qatar's halted LNG exports amid Middle East conflict, risking power generation. Gov't explores spot LNG but finds it unviable vs. RFO costs. Export of furnace oil banned pending PM approval. High-efficiency RLNG plants remain critical; load shedding may follow if supply persists....

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Oil shock may cost Pakistan 1.5pc of GDP: experts - Pakistan - DAWN.COM

Pakistan faces \$12–14bn external shock from soaring oil prices and remittance losses, risking a \$6bn current account deficit. Renewables and indigenous energy must rapidly expand to replace LNG reliance. IMF pressure may demand deeper concessions. Austerity measures are ineffective; real solutions require infrastructure investment, fuel price flexibility, and avoiding regional conflict escalation....

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Committee reviews fuel stock position, import arrangements

Pakistan's energy committee confirms stable petrol stocks amid global volatility, with coordinated supply efforts and digital monitoring systems. Finance Minister stresses domestic security and conservation measures to ease import pressure, while maintaining uninterrupted fuel access despite regional tensions....

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Power Div challenges AGP report - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Pakistan's power sector sees reduced circular debt (Rs 780B) amid Disco inefficiencies, despite claims of structural reform. Power Division challenges Audit findings, citing K-Electric's debt contributions and tariff surcharge removal as part of a phased settlement plan over 5–6 years, aiming for long-term cost relief and operational improvement....

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Power generation merger hits bureaucratic roadblock - Business - DAWN.COM

Pakistan's energy task force approved merging redundant Gencos and GHCL into NPPMC to cut costs and streamline operations. Bureaucrats resist, citing perks and staffing; delays persist despite ministerial orders. Financial savings target over Rs4 trillion. Renewables not mentioned in this update....

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Petroleum products: Supply chains functional, panel told - Business Recorder

Pakistan's energy committee confirms stable petroleum stocks amid global volatility, prioritizing supply chain continuity. Proactive import arrangements, digital monitoring, and conservation measures are in place. Government emphasizes coordination across sectors to safeguard energy security and economic stability during regional market disruptions....

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'Govt absorbs Rs77 fuel price hike'

Pakistan's government absorbed Rs77/litre diesel and Rs48/litre petrol price hikes to avoid consumer spikes, but lacks clarity on how it will offset costs. Industry warns of supply chain strain, misleading social media comparisons (Brent vs Dubai benchmarks), and stalled policies like Brownfield Refining. State-owned firms dominate, and pricing is based on refined product indices—not crude alone....

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Misc

Govt to pay Rs23bn to OMCs to keep petrol, diesel prices unchanged

Pakistan's government maintains petrol/diesel prices unchanged amid rising global oil costs, compensating OMCs with Rs23B via OGRA. Funded by a newly approved austerity fund, this move aims to curb inflation but strains public finances. No major renewables developments reported....

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Govt Decides to Maintain Over Rs. 100 Levy on Petrol

Govt maintains petrol/diesel levies at Rs. 105.37/dl & Rs. 55.24/dl, subsidizing with Rs. 23B via OGRA. Cabinet approves Rs. 27.1B Austerity Fund; DG Oil directs OGRA on payment mechanism. No major renewables or financial results highlighted in this update....

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Five killed in Russian air attacks on Ukraine

Russia launched heavy attacks on Ukraine's energy infrastructure, killing five and disrupting power across six regions. Ukraine retaliates with strikes on Russian targets. NATO allies bolster defenses amid Iran conflict distraction. Renewables remain key as Russia's winter campaign weakens Ukrainian resilience—though no major renewables breakthroughs reported....

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Fuel price hike starts hurting economy

Pakistan's Rs55/litre petroleum price hike has alarmed businesses, with PCDMA warning of severe economic damage. Traders face unsustainable costs, threatening commerce. The association urges PM Shehbaz Sharif to act swiftly to alleviate the financial strain amid ongoing economic pressures. No renewables or financial results mentioned....

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Selective exceptions, strategic consequences - Editorials - Business Recorder

Pakistan objects to India-Canada's uranium supply deal, citing unfairness in global nuclear cooperation. The agreement grants India privileged access amid partial non-compliance with IAEA safeguards, raising proliferation and strategic stability concerns. Pakistan urges a rules-based, non-discriminatory framework for civilian nuclear trade....

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Business Recorder

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US natural gas futures slide - Markets - Business Recorder

US natural gas futures dipped on mild March weather easing demand, with storage injections boosting supplies. Gas prices remain stable amid pipeline constraints and low export capacity. Global gas prices rose sharply post-Iran war, but US markets reacted less due to self-sufficiency. Renewables not mentioned; focus remains on gas supply, weather, and geopolitical impacts....

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Business Recorder

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No hike in petrol and HSD prices, PD decides - Business Recorder

Pakistan maintains petrol & diesel prices amid rising Petroleum Levy (PL) from Rs84.40 to Rs105.37/litre, boosting non-tax revenue toward IMF targets. Dealers urge higher margins; GST remains zero, limiting tax burden. PL collection exceeds budgeted targets, with renewables not mentioned in this update....

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Karachi citizens fume as unannounced gas cuts continue to disrupt Sehri cooking, Iftar - Pakistan - DAWN.COM

Karachi faces severe gas shortages due to Qatar's LNG suspension amid Iran-Iraq tensions. Unannounced supply cuts disrupt Ramazan routines; residents turn to costly LPG/electric stoves. SSGC's lack of transparency fuels frustration, while renewables remain underutilized amid inflation and energy insecurity....

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Dawn

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Iran holds the key to reopening global energy markets - World - DAWN.COM

Gulf conflict disrupts global energy. Iran's drone strikes shut Hormuz, forcing oil exports via alternative routes. Saudi Aramco halts production; Iraq and UAE cut output sharply. LNG cuts from Qatar. Market volatility surges 60%; insurers wary of risk. US military escorts unlikely to resolve tensions without Tehran concessions. Renewables not impacted; crisis exposes supply chain fragility....

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One of Britain's last major chemical plants at risk as energy prices surge

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Beyond the strait: why an attack on Kargh Island could keep oil prices high

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The Guardian

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Oil company shares soar to all-time highs as Middle East war turbocharges price per barrel

Iran conflict-triggered energy price surges have boosted oil giants' stock valuations by \$130bn+ in two weeks, with Shell, Exxon, Chevron, and BP seeing major gains. Critics urge windfall taxes to protect households, while renewables advocates warn against fuel duty cuts amid soaring profits....

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UK may send ships and mine-hunting drones to help open strait of Hormuz, says Miliband

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